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# Seunghyun Lewis Kwon, Ph.D.

Sejong, Republic of Korea

lewis.kwon@kdis.ac.kr | linkedin.com/in/lewiskwon | ORCID: 0000-0002-0113-0179

## Position

Senior Deputy Director, Division of Infectious Disease Control, KDCA — Aug. 2025–Present

## Education

**Ph.D. Public Policy, KDI School of Public Policy and Management** — 2025

*Dissertation: Three Essays on Immunization: Impact, Perception, and the Decision-Making Process*

**MBA, Rotterdam School of Management, Erasmus University** — 2018

**Master of Development Policy, KDI School of Public Policy and Management** — 2017

**B.A. Economics and English, Handong Global University** — 2008

## Fields of Expertise

Viral hepatitis elimination; immunization policy; adult vaccination; epidemic intelligence; surveillance-system integration; emergency response governance; vaccine hesitancy; public health decision-making; global health security capacity-building.

## Professional Experience

**Korea Disease Control and Prevention Agency (KDCA)** — 2020–Present

*Senior Deputy Director / Deputy Director*

- Lead national policy and strategic planning for viral hepatitis prevention and control aligned with WHO 2030 elimination goals.
- Manage integration of hepatitis surveillance data and clinical datasets to strengthen early detection and public health outcomes.
- Led major immunization and emergency-response functions, including rotavirus NIP introduction, COVID-19 risk assessment and 3T strategy, Mpox vaccination, and surveillance modernization.

**Ministry of Health and Welfare** — 2009–2020

*Assistant Director*

- Managed infectious disease control planning, budget coordination, inter-government cooperation, and pandemic preparedness assessment.
- Led or supported major response and policy functions for Ebola, MERS, infectious disease legislation, long-term care infection control, and international cooperation with WHO and UNICEF.
- Executed quarantine, rapid testing, and vaccine-distribution functions during the H1N1 epidemic response.

## Publications

### 2026

- **Kwon, S. L.**, Shin, N., & Park, C.-B. (2026). Adolescent suicide in South Korea: A sex-specific reversal and the need for targeted prevention policy. *Asian Journal of Psychiatry*, 123, 105093.
- **Kwon, S. L.**, Kang, S.-K., Lee, J., Lee, G., & Lee, H. (2026). Maintaining infectious disease surveillance during a national IT outage: lessons from the Republic of Korea's 2025 data centre fire. *Western Pacific Surveillance and Response Journal*, 16(5).
- Kang, S.-K., **Kwon, S. L.**, Yu, J., Yang, S., Lee, H., Koh, D., Jang, H., & Lee, H. (2026). Results of the National Health Screening Program for Hepatitis C among 56-year-olds, Republic of Korea, 2025. *Public Health Weekly Report*, 19(28), 1148–1167.

### 2025

- **Kwon, S. L.**, & Choi, S. W. (2025). Vaccination in the shadow of uncertainty: Exploring the links between government trust and COVID-19 vaccine acceptance. *Human Vaccines & Immunotherapeutics*, 21(1).
- Kim, A. R., Achanwanga, C., Do, H. N., Jang, E. Y., Nam, Y., Cho, S., Kim, T., Jeong, H. S., Rhie, G. E., Oh, K., **Kwon, S. L.**, Lee, S., Lee, J., & Ryu, S. (2025). Seroprevalence trends of antibodies to SARS-CoV-2 in South Korea, 2021–2022: A repeated cross-sectional study. *Influenza and Other Respiratory Viruses*, 19(6), e70117.
- Kang, S. K., **Kwon, S. L.**, et al. (2025). Trends and epidemiological characteristics of acute hepatitis B among foreign nationals in the Republic of Korea, 2014–2024. *Public Health Weekly Report*, 18(44).
- Kim, S. Y., Song, M., & **Kwon, S. L.** (2025). Impact of caregiver vaccination status on child influenza vaccination hesitancy. *Vaccine*, 49, 126852.
- Kim, S. Y., Jeong, H. J., Ko, H., **Kwon, S. L.**, & Lee, D. (2025). Strengthening national immunization program governance. *Vaccine: X*, 24.

### 2024

- **Kwon, S. L.**, Kim, S. Y., Song, M., et al. (2024). Assessing the determinants of influenza and COVID-19 vaccine co-administration decisions in the elderly. *Human Vaccines & Immunotherapeutics*, 20(1).
- **Kwon, S. L.**, Song, M., Lee, W., et al. (2024). First nationwide Mpox vaccination program in the Republic of Korea: Implications for an enhanced public health response. *Journal of Korean Medical Science*, 39(32).
- Kim, J., Song, M., Ahn, S., & **Kwon, S. L.** (2024). Twenty years of progress and the way forward: Immunization registry information system in Korea. *Journal of Korean Medical Science*, 39(12).
- Cho, J., Kim, E. M., Kim, J., Shin, J.-Y., Kim, E. H., Park, J. H., **Kwon, S. L.**, Kwon, G.-Y., Shin, S.-A., & Kim, J. (2024). Effect of the human papillomavirus vaccine on the risk of genital warts: a nationwide cohort study of Korean adolescent girls. *Epidemiology and Health*, 46, e2024040.

### 2023

- **Kwon, S. L.**, & Kim, B. I. (2023). How COVID-19 shifted the seasonal flu in Korea. *Influenza and Other Respiratory Viruses*, 17(3).
- Lee, J., **Kwon, S. L.**, Park, J., et al. (2023). JYNNEOS vaccine safety monitoring in the Republic of Korea, 2022. *Osong Public Health and Research Perspectives*, 14(5).
- Kim, S. J., **Kwon, S. L.**, Lee, J. Y., et al. (2023). Why school is crucial to increase vaccination coverage for children. *Vaccine*, 41(21).

### 2021–2022

- **Kwon, S. L.**, Ban, S., Shin, J., et al. (2022). Monkeypox vaccination in the Republic of Korea. *Journal of*

*Korean Medical Science*, 37(29).

- **Kwon, S. L.**, & Oh, J. (2022). COVID-19 vaccination program in South Korea: A long journey toward a new normal. *Health Policy and Technology*, 11(2).

## Invited Presentations and Lectures

### 2026

- **Korea's Infectious Disease Control Policy** Sep. 2026
  Lecturer, *KOICA Invitational Training Program for the Ministry of Health, Kenya*, KOICA / GC Labs, Seoul, Republic of Korea
- **Infectious Disease Surveillance System: Data to Action** Jul. 2026
  Lecturer, *Infectious Disease Specialist Course of the Lee Jong-wook Fellowship Program*, Korea University / GC Labs consortium, Seoul, Republic of Korea
- **Decision-Making Process for Hepatitis C Screening in Korea's National Health Screening System** Jun. 2026
  Speaker, *The Liver Week 2026*, Seoul, Republic of Korea
- **Infectious Disease Characteristics and Countermeasures** Mar. 2026
  Speaker, *Regional Safety Capacity Improvement Joint Workshop*, National Disaster Management Research Institute, Cheongju OSCO, Republic of Korea

### 2025

- **Korea's Adult Immunization Strategy** Sep. 2025
  Speaker, *Strengthening Adult Immunization Policy in APEC: Regional Alignment and Global Engagement*, IVI side event during the APEC High-Level Meeting on Health and the Economy and World Bio Summit 2025, Seoul, Republic of Korea
- **Strengthening Evidence-Based Vaccine Decision-Making** Sep. 2025
  Speaker, *Vaccinology: Science and Public Health Symposium*, Nagasaki University / London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine / International Vaccine Institute, Nagasaki, Japan
- **Korea's National Immunization Policy** Aug. 2025
  lecturer, *Lee Jong-wook Fellowship Infectious Disease Expert Course*, Korea University / Korea Foundation for International Healthcare, Seoul, Republic of Korea
- **Overcoming Vaccine Hesitancy** Jun. 2025
  lecturer, *Global Training Hub for Biomanufacturing (GTH-B)*, International Vaccine Institute, Seoul, Republic of Korea

### 2024

- **Communicating Science to the Public: Vaccine Hesitancy** Sep. 2024
  Speaker, *ASEAN Vaccine Security and Self-Reliance (AVSSR) Vaccine Human Resource Development Program*, Bangkok, Thailand
- **Field-Based Competency Development for Public Officials** Apr. and Sep. 2024
  lecturer, *6th-grade Core Competency Enhancement Course* (Cohorts 1 and 2), Korea Human Resource Development Institute for Health and Welfare (KOHI), Osong, Republic of Korea

## Awards

KDCA Commissioner's Award 2025
Order of Civil Merit by the President of Korea, Sierra Leone Ebola response contribution 2015
Health and Welfare Minister's Award 2007